

ABHIMANI WOMEN'S COLLECTIVE - SRI LANKA

KNOW YOUR RIGHTS: POCKET LEGAL GUIDE

24/7 Rapid Response & Bail Hotline: +94 77 123 4567 | legal@awc.lk

1. CONSTITUTIONAL PROTECTIONS (1978 CONSTITUTION):

- Article 11: Absolute freedom from torture, physical assault, or degrading police treatment.
- Article 12: Equal protection of the law regardless of gender identity or sex work.
- Article 13(1): Freedom from arbitrary arrest. Officers must state the legal reason for arrest.
- Article 13(2): Mandatory appearance before a Magistrate within 24 hours.

2. POLICE SEARCH PROTOCOLS (CODE OF CRIMINAL PROCEDURE ACT NO. 15 OF 1979):

- Section 30: Female bodies can ONLY be searched by female police officers.
- Searches must be conducted with strict regard to decency in private - never on the open street.
- Condoms are NOT illegal and cannot legally be cited as evidence of criminal activity.
- Phone searches require reasonable cause or a court warrant. Do not unlock under duress.

3. POLICE STATION RIGHTS & ARREST PROTOCOL:

- You have the immediate right to make a phone call to AWC (+94 77 123 4567) or a lawyer.
- Do not sign blank sheets, unsigned statements, or confessions under intimidation.
- Ensure all cash, mobile phones, and jewellery are entered into the Station Diary (IB).